

Grand Ridge CCSD #95

Employee Handbook

Revised 07/29/2024

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Vision

“In partnership with our families and community, Grand Ridge CCSD #95 will educate all students to reach their highest potential. Grand Ridge will provide a safe learning environment, will respond to students’ individual learning and emotional needs, and will maintain high expectations for achievement. Our goal is to develop students who are responsible, respectful, kind, and passionate for life-long learning.”

Grand Ridge Board of Education Goals (2022-2027)

Goal 1: Curriculum Development

The District will provide competitive curriculum that represents our community values for students in Preschool through grade 8 by establishing a preschool program, and developing and supporting student competence through advanced programs.

Goal 2: Hiring and Retention

The District will cultivate a positive and supportive environment through a unified School Board and Administration committed to providing the resources necessary to make our staff and school body successful.

Goal 3: Budget and Finance

Maintain a balanced budget and healthy reserves in operating funds, while leveraging grant opportunities and being mindful of our taxpayers and community.

Goal 4: Technology and Innovation

Support our community, students, staff, and teachers in keeping up with current technology skills and encourage innovative practices.

Goal 5: Building Operations and Maintenance

Provide and maintain a safe and comfortable learning environment while responsibly prioritizing projects.

Goal 6: Community Relations

Get the community into the school as well as getting the school into the community.

Board Policy 2:270 Discrimination and Harassment on the Basis of Race, Color, and National Origin Prohibited

Discrimination and harassment on the basis of race, color, or national origin negatively affect a student's ability to learn and an employee's ability to work. Providing an educational and workplace environment free from such discrimination and harassment is an important District goal. The District does not discriminate on the basis of actual or perceived race, color, or national origin in any of its education programs or activities, and it complies with federal and State non-discrimination laws.

Examples of Prohibited Conduct

Examples of conduct that may constitute discrimination on the basis of race, color, or national origin include: disciplining students more harshly and frequently because of their race, color, or national origin; denying students access to high-rigor academic courses, extracurricular activities, or other educational opportunities based on their race, color, or national origin; denying language services or other educational opportunities to English learners; and assigning students special education services based on a student's race, color, or national origin.

Harassment is a form of prohibited discrimination. Examples of conduct that may constitute harassment on the basis of race, color, or national origin include: the use of racial, ethnic or ancestral slurs or stereotypes; taunts; name-calling; offensive or derogatory remarks about a person's actual or perceived race, color, or national origin; the display of racially-offensive symbols; racially-motivated physical threats and attacks; or other hateful conduct.

Making a Report or Complaint; Investigation Process

Individuals are encouraged to promptly report claims or incidences of discrimination or harassment based on race, color, or national origin to the Nondiscrimination Coordinator, a Complaint Manager, or any employee with whom the student is comfortable speaking. Reports under this policy will be processed under Board policy 2:260, *Uniform Grievance Procedure*.

Any District employee who receives a report or complaint of discrimination or harassment must promptly forward the report or complaint to the Nondiscrimination Coordinator or a Complaint Manager. Any employee who fails to promptly comply may be disciplined, up to and including discharge.

Reports and complaints of discrimination or harassment will be confidential to the greatest extent practicable, subject to the District's duty to investigate and maintain an educational environment that is productive, respectful, and free of unlawful discrimination, including harassment.

This policy does not impair or otherwise diminish the existing rights of unionized employees to request an exclusive bargaining representative to be present during any investigatory interviews, nor does this policy diminish any rights available under an applicable collective bargaining agreement, including, but not limited to, a grievance procedure.

Federal and State Agencies

If the District fails to take necessary corrective action to stop harassment based on race, color, or national origin, further relief may be available through the Ill. Dept. of Human Rights (IDHR) or the U.S. Dept. of Education's Office for Civil Rights. To contact IDHR, go to: <https://dhr.illinois.gov/about-us/contact-idhr.html> or call (312) 814-6200 (Chicago) or (217) 785-5100 (Springfield).

Prevention and Response Program

The Superintendent or designee shall establish a prevention and response program to respond to complaints of discrimination based on race, color, and national origin, including harassment, and retaliation. The program shall include procedures for responding to complaints which:

1. Reduce or remove, to the extent practicable, barriers to reporting discrimination, harassment, and retaliation;
2. Permit any person who reports or is the victim of an incident of alleged discrimination, harassment, or retaliation to be accompanied when making a report by a support individual of the person's choice who complies with the District's policies and rules;
3. Permit anonymous reporting, except that an anonymous report may not be the sole basis of any disciplinary action;
4. Offer remedial interventions or take such disciplinary action as may be appropriate on a case-by-case basis;
5. Offer, but do not require or unduly influence, a person who reports or is the victim of an incident of harassment or retaliation the option to resolve allegations directly with the accused; and
6. Protects a person who reports or is the victim of an incident of harassment or retaliation from suffering adverse consequences as a result of a report of, investigation of, or a response to the incident.

Policy Posting and Distribution

This policy shall be posted on the District's website. The Superintendent shall annually inform staff members of this policy by posting it in a prominent and accessible location such as the District website, employee handbook, staff intranet site, and/or in other areas where policies and rules of conduct are made available to staff. The Superintendent shall annually inform students and their parents/guardians of this policy by posting it on the

District's website and including an age-appropriate summary of the policy in the student handbook(s).

Enforcement

Any District employee who is determined, after an investigation, to have engaged in conduct prohibited by this policy will be subject to remedial action and/or disciplinary action, up to and including discharge.

Any District student who is determined, after an investigation, to have engaged in conduct prohibited by this policy will be subject to remedial action and/or disciplinary action, including but not limited to, suspension and expulsion consistent with Board policy 7:190, *Student Behavior*.

Any third party who is determined, after an investigation, to have engaged in conduct prohibited by this policy will be addressed in accordance with the authority of the Board in the context of the relationship of the third party to the District, e.g., vendor, parent, invitee, etc. Any person making a knowingly false accusation regarding prohibited conduct will likewise be subject to remedial and/or disciplinary action.

Retaliation Prohibited

Retaliation against any person for bringing complaints, participating in the complaint process, or otherwise providing information about discrimination or harassment based on race, color, or national origin is prohibited (see Board policy 2:260, *Uniform Grievance Procedure*).

Individuals should report allegations of retaliation to the Building Principal, an administrator, the Nondiscrimination Coordinator, and/or a Complaint Manager.

Adopted: June 11, 2024

General Personnel

5:120 Employee Ethics; Code of Professional Conduct; and Conflict of Interest

All District employees are expected to maintain high standards in their job performance, demonstrate integrity and honesty, be considerate and cooperative, and maintain professional and appropriate relationships with students, parents/guardians, staff members, and others.

The Superintendent or designee shall provide this policy to all District employees and students and/or parents/guardians in their respective handbooks, and ensure its posting on the District's website, if any.

Professional and Appropriate Conduct

Professional and appropriate employee conduct are important Board goals that impact the quality of a safe learning environment and the school community, increasing students' ability to learn and the District's ability to educate. To protect students from sexual misconduct by employees, and employees from the appearance of impropriety, State law also recognizes the importance for District employees to constantly maintain professional and appropriate relationships with students by following established expectations and guidelines for employee-student boundaries. Many breaches of employee-student boundaries do not rise to the level of criminal behavior but do pose a potential risk to student safety and impact the quality of a safe learning environment. Repeated violations of employee-student boundaries may indicate the grooming of a student for sexual abuse. As bystanders, employees may know of concerning behaviors that no one else is aware of, so their training on: (1) preventing, recognizing, reporting, and responding to child sexual abuse and grooming behavior; (2) this policy; and (3) federal and state reporting requirements is essential to maintaining the Board's goal of professional and appropriate conduct.

The Superintendent or designee shall identify employee conduct standards that define appropriate employee-student boundaries, provide training about them, and monitor the District's employees for violations of employee-student boundaries. The employee conduct standards will require that, at a minimum:

1. Employees who are governed by the *Code of Ethics for Illinois Educators*, adopted by the Ill. State Board of Education (ISBE), will comply with its incorporation by reference into this policy.
2. Employees are trained on educator ethics, child abuse, grooming behaviors, and employee-student boundary violations as required by law and policies 2:265, *Title IX Grievance Procedure*; 4:165, *Awareness and Prevention of Child Sexual Abuse and Grooming Behaviors*; 5:90, *Abused and Neglected Child Reporting*; and 5:100, *Staff Development Program*.
3. Employees maintain professional relationships with students, including maintaining employee-student boundaries based upon students' ages, grade levels,

and developmental levels and following District-established guidelines for specific situations, including but not limited to:

- a. Transporting a student;
 - b. Taking or possessing a photo or video of a student; and
 - c. Meeting with a student or contacting a student outside the employee's professional role.
4. Employees report prohibited behaviors and/or boundary violations pursuant to Board policies 2:260, *Uniform Grievance Procedure*; 2:265, *Title IX Grievance Procedure*; and 5:90, *Abused and Neglected Child Reporting*.
 5. Discipline up to and including dismissal will occur for any employee who violates an employee conduct standard or engages in any of the following:
 - a. Violates expectations and guidelines for employee-student boundaries.
 - b. Sexually harasses a student.
 - c. Willfully or negligently fails to follow reporting requirements of the Abused and Neglected Child Reporting Act ([325 ILCS 5/](#)), Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972 ([20 U.S.C. §1681 et seq.](#)), or the Elementary and Secondary Education Act ([20 U.S.C. § 7926](#)).
 - d. Engages in *grooming* as defined in [720 ILCS 5/11-25](#).
 - e. Engages in grooming behaviors. Prohibited grooming behaviors include, at a minimum, *sexual misconduct*. *Sexual misconduct* is any act, including but not limited to, any verbal, nonverbal, written, or electronic communication or physical activity, by an employee with direct contact with a student, that is directed toward or with a student to establish a romantic or sexual relationship with the student. Examples include, but are not limited to:
 - i. A sexual or romantic invitation.
 - ii. Dating or soliciting a date.
 - iii. Engaging in sexualized or romantic dialog.
 - iv. Making sexually suggestive comments that are directed toward or with a student.
 - v. Self-disclosure or physical exposure of a sexual, romantic, or erotic nature.
 - vi. A sexual, indecent, romantic, or erotic contact with the student.

Statement of Economic Interests

The following employees must file a *Statement of Economic Interests* as required by the Ill. Governmental Ethics Act:

1. Superintendent;
2. Building Principal;
3. Head of any department;
4. Any employee who, as the District's agent, is responsible for negotiating one or more contracts, including collective bargaining agreement(s), in the amount of \$1,000 or greater;

5. Hearing officer;
6. Any employee having supervisory authority for 20 or more employees; and
7. Any employee in a position that requires an administrative or a chief school business official endorsement.

Ethics and Gift Ban

Board policy 2:105, *Ethics and Gift Ban*, applies to all District employees. Students shall not be used in any manner for promoting a political candidate or issue.

Prohibited Interests; Conflict of Interest; and Limitation of Authority

In accordance with [105 ILCS 5/22-5](#), “no school officer or teacher shall be interested in the sale, proceeds, or profits of any book, apparatus, or furniture used or to be used in any school with which such officer or teacher may be connected,” except when the employee is the author or developer of instructional materials listed with ISBE and adopted for use by the Board. An employee having an interest in instructional materials must file an annual statement with the Board Secretary.

For the purpose of acquiring profit or personal gain, no employee shall act as an agent of the District nor shall an employee act as an agent of any business in any transaction with the District. This includes participation in the selection, award, or administration of a contract supported by a federal award or State award governed by the Grant Accountability and Transparency Act (GATA) ([30 ILCS 708/](#)) when the employee has a real or apparent conflict of interest. A conflict of interest arises when an employee or any of the following individuals has a financial or other interest in or a tangible benefit from the entity selected for the contract:

1. A member of the employee’s immediate family;
2. An employee’s partner; or
3. An entity that employs or is about to employ the employee or one of the individuals listed in one or two above.

Employees shall neither solicit nor accept gratuities, favors, or anything of monetary value from contractors, potential contractors, or parties to agreements or subcontracts. Situations in which the interest is not substantial or the gift is an unsolicited item of nominal value must comply with State law and Board policy 2:105, *Ethics and Gift Ban*.

Outside Employment

Employees shall not engage in any other employment or in any private business during regular working hours or at such other times as are necessary to fulfill appropriate assigned duties. Incorporated by reference: 5:120-E (Code of Ethics for Ill. Educators)
Adopted: January 10, 2023

7:180 Prevention of and Response to Bullying, Intimidation, and Harassment

Bullying, intimidation, and harassment diminish a student's ability to learn and a school's ability to educate. Preventing students from engaging in these disruptive behaviors and providing all students equal access to a safe, non-hostile learning environment are important District goals.

Bullying on the basis of actual or perceived race, color, religion, sex, national origin, ancestry, physical appearance, socioeconomic status, academic status, pregnancy, parenting status, homelessness, age, marital status, physical or mental disability, military status, sexual orientation, gender-related identity or expression, unfavorable discharge from military service, order of protection status, association with a person or group with one or more of the aforementioned actual or perceived characteristics, or any other distinguishing characteristic **is prohibited** in each of the following situations:

1. During any school-sponsored education program or activity.
2. While in school, on school property, on school buses or other school vehicles, at designated school bus stops waiting for the school bus, or at school-sponsored or school-sanctioned events or activities.
3. Through the transmission of information from a school computer, a school computer network, or other similar electronic school equipment.
4. Through the transmission of information from a computer that is accessed at a non school-related location, activity, function, or program or from the use of technology or an electronic device that is not owned, leased, or used by a the School District or school if the bullying causes a substantial disruption to the educational process or orderly operation of a school. This paragraph (item #4) applies only when a school administrator or teacher receives a report that bullying through this means has occurred; it does not require staff members to monitor any nonschool-related activity, function, or program.

Definitions from [105 ILCS 5/27-23.7](#)

Bullying includes *cyberbullying* and means any severe or pervasive physical or verbal act or conduct, including communications made in writing or electronically, directed toward a student or students that has or can be reasonably predicted to have the effect of one or more of the following:

1. Placing the student or students in reasonable fear of harm to the student's or students' person or property;
2. Causing a substantially detrimental effect on the student's or students' physical or mental health;
3. Substantially interfering with the student's or students' academic performance; or
4. Substantially interfering with the student's or students' ability to participate in or benefit from the services, activities, or privileges provided by a school.

Bullying may take various forms, including without limitation one or more of the following: harassment, threats, intimidation, stalking, physical violence, sexual harassment, sexual violence, theft, public humiliation, destruction of property, or retaliation for asserting or alleging an act of bullying. This list is meant to be illustrative and non-exhaustive.

Cyberbullying means bullying through the use of technology or any electronic communication, including without limitation any transfer of signs, signals, writing, images, sounds, data, or intelligence of any nature transmitted in whole or in part by a wire, radio, electromagnetic system, photo-electronic system, or photo-optical system, including without limitation electronic mail, Internet communications, instant messages, or facsimile communications. *Cyberbullying* includes the creation of a webpage or weblog in which the creator assumes the identity of another person or the knowing impersonation of another person as the author of posted content or messages if the creation or impersonation creates any of the effects enumerated in the definition of *bullying*. *Cyberbullying* also includes the distribution by electronic means of a communication to more than one person or the posting of material on an electronic medium that may be accessed by one or more persons if the distribution or posting creates any of the effects enumerated in the definition of *bullying*.

Restorative measures means a continuum of school-based alternatives to exclusionary discipline, such as suspensions and expulsions, that: (i) are adapted to the particular needs of the school and community, (ii) contribute to maintaining school safety, (iii) protect the integrity of a positive and productive learning climate, (iv) teach students the personal and interpersonal skills they will need to be successful in school and society, (v) serve to build and restore relationships among students, families, schools, and communities, (vi) reduce the likelihood of future disruption by balancing accountability with an understanding of students' behavioral health needs in order to keep students in school, and (vii) increase student accountability if the incident of bullying is based on religion, race, ethnicity, or any other category that is identified in the Ill. Human Rights Act.

School personnel means persons employed by, on contract with, or who volunteer in a school district, including without limitation school and school district administrators, teachers, school social workers, school counselors, school psychologists, school nurses, cafeteria workers, custodians, bus drivers, school resource officers, and security guards.

Bullying Prevention and Response Plan

The Superintendent or designee shall develop and maintain a bullying prevention and response plan that advances the District's goal of providing all students with a safe learning environment free of bullying and harassment. This plan must be consistent with the requirements listed below.

1. The District uses the definition of *bullying* as provided in this policy.
2. Bullying is contrary to State law and the policy of this District. However, nothing in the District's bullying prevention and response plan is intended to infringe

- upon any right to exercise free expression or the free exercise of religion or religiously based views protected under the [First Amendment to the U.S. Constitution](#) or under [Section 3 of Article I of the Illinois Constitution](#).
3. Students are encouraged to immediately report bullying. A report may be made orally or in writing to the Nondiscrimination Coordinator, Building Principal, Assistant Building Principal, Dean of Students, a Complaint Manager, or any staff member with whom the student is comfortable speaking. Anyone, including staff members and parents/guardians, who has information about actual or threatened bullying is encouraged to report it to the District named officials or any staff member. The District named officials and all staff members are available for help with a bully or to make a report about bullying. Anonymous reports are also accepted.; however, this shall not be construed to permit formal disciplinary action solely on the basis of an anonymous report

Nondiscrimination Coordinator:

Ted Sanders,

Superintendent
Grand Ridge CCSD 95

400 W. Main St.,

Grand Ridge, IL 61325
sandet@grgs95.org
(815) 249-6225

Complaint Managers:

Terry Ahearn,	Amber Grenda,
Principal	School Guidance Counselor
Grand Ridge CCSD 95	Grand Ridge CCSD 95
400 W. Main St.,	400 W. Main St.,
Grand Ridge, IL 61325	Grand Ridge, IL 61325
aheart@grgs95.org	grenda@grgs95.org
(815) 249-6225	(815) 249-6225

4. Consistent with federal and State laws and rules governing student privacy rights, the parents/guardians of all students involved in an alleged incident of bullying will be notified of such, along with threats, suggestions, or instances of self-harm determined to be the result of bullying, within 24 hours after the school's administration is made aware of the student's involvement in the incident. As appropriate, the school's administration shall also discuss the availability of social

work services, counseling, school psychological services, other interventions, and restorative measures. The school shall make diligent efforts to notify a parent or legal guardian, utilizing all contact information the school has available or that can be reasonably obtained within the 24-hour period.

5. The Superintendent or designee shall promptly investigate and address reports of bullying, by, among other things:
 - a. Making all reasonable efforts to complete the investigation within 10 school days after the date the report of a bullying incident was received and taking into consideration additional relevant information received during the course of the investigation about the reported bullying incident.
 - b. Involving appropriate school support personnel and other staff persons with knowledge, experience, and training on bullying prevention, as deemed appropriate, in the investigation process.
 - c. Notifying the Building Principal or school administrator or designee of the reported incident of bullying as soon as possible after the report is received.
 - d. Consistent with federal and State laws and rules governing student privacy rights, providing parents/guardians of the students who are parties to the investigation information about the investigation and an opportunity to meet with the Building Principal or school administrator or his or her designee to discuss the investigation, the findings of the investigation, and the actions taken to address the reported incident of bullying.

The Superintendent or designee shall investigate whether a reported incident of bullying is within the permissible scope of the District's jurisdiction and shall require that the District provide the victim with information regarding services that are available within the District and community, such as counseling, support services, and other programs.

6. The Superintendent or designee shall use interventions to address bullying, that may include, but are not limited to, school social work services, restorative measures, social-emotional skill building, counseling, school psychological services, and community-based services.
7. A reprisal or retaliation against any person who reports an act of bullying **is prohibited**. Any person's act of reprisal or retaliation will be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including discharge with regard to employees, or suspension and/or expulsion with regard to students.
8. A student will not be punished for reporting bullying or supplying information, even if the District's investigation concludes that no bullying occurred. However, a person who is found to have falsely accused another of bullying, as a means of retaliation, as a means of bullying, or provided false information will be treated as either: (a) *bullying*, (b) student discipline up to and including suspension and/or expulsion, and/or (c) both (a) and (b) for purposes of determining any consequences or other appropriate remedial actions.
9. The District's bullying prevention and response plan is based on the engagement of a range of school stakeholders, including students and parents/guardians.

10. The Superintendent or designee shall post this policy on the District's publicly accessible website, if any, and include it in the student handbook, and, where applicable, post it where other policies, rules, and standards of conduct are currently posted. The policy must be distributed annually to parents/guardians, students, and school personnel (including new employees when hired), and must also be provided periodically throughout the school year to students and faculty.
11. Pursuant to State law and Board policy 2:240, *Board Policy Development*, the Board monitors this policy every two years by conducting a review and re-evaluation of this policy to make any necessary and appropriate revisions. The Superintendent or designee shall assist the Board with its re-evaluation and assessment of this policy's outcomes and effectiveness. Updates to this policy will reflect any necessary and appropriate revisions. This process shall include, without limitation:
 - a. The frequency of victimization;
 - b. Student, staff, and family observations of safety at a school;
 - c. Identification of areas of a school where bullying occurs;
 - d. The types of bullying utilized; and
 - e. Bystander intervention or participation.

The evaluation process may use relevant data and information that the District already collects for other purposes. Acceptable documentation to satisfy the re-evaluated policy submission include one of the following:

- 1) An updated version of the policy with the amendment/modification date included in the reference portion of the policy;
- 2) If no revisions are deemed necessary, a copy of board minutes indicating that the policy was re-evaluated and no changes were deemed to be necessary; or
- 3) A signed statement from the Board President indicating that the Board re-evaluated the policy and no changes to it were necessary.

The Superintendent or designee must post the information developed as a result of the policy re-evaluation on the District's website, or if a website is not available, the information must be provided to school administrators, Board members, school personnel, parents/guardians, and students. Reviews and re-evaluations in years they are due must be submitted to ISBE by September 30.

12. The Superintendent or designee shall fully implement the Board policies, including without limitation, the following:
 - a. 2:260, *Uniform Grievance Procedure*. A student may use this policy to complain about bullying.

- b. 2:265, *Title IX Grievance Procedure*. Any person may use this policy to complain about sexual harassment in violation of Title IX of the Education Amendments of 1972.
 - c. 2:270, *Discrimination and Harassment on the Basis of Race, Color, and National Origin Prohibited*. Any person may use this policy to complain about discrimination or harassment on the basis of race, color, or national origin in violation of Title VI of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 and/or the Illinois Human Rights Act.
 - d. 6:60, *Curriculum Content*. Bullying prevention and character instruction is provided in all grades in accordance with State law.
 - e. 6:65, *Student Social and Emotional Development*. Student social and emotional development is incorporated into the District's educational program as required by State law.
 - f. 6:235, *Access to Electronic Networks*. This policy states that the use of the District's electronic networks is limited to: (1) support of education and/or research, or (2) a legitimate business use.
 - g. 7:20, *Harassment of Students Prohibited*. This policy prohibits any person from harassing, intimidating, or bullying a student based on an identified actual or perceived characteristic (the list of characteristics in 7:20 is the same as the list in this policy).
 - h. 7:185, *Teen Dating Violence Prohibited*. This policy prohibits teen dating violence on school property, at school sponsored activities, and in vehicles used for school-provided transportation.
 - i. 7:190, *Student Behavior*. This policy prohibits, and provides consequences for, hazing, bullying, or other aggressive behaviors, or urging other students to engage in such conduct.
 - j. 7:310, *Restrictions on Publications; Elementary Schools*. This policy prohibits students from and provides consequences for: (1) accessing and/or distributing at school any written, printed, or electronic material, including material from the Internet, that will cause substantial disruption of the proper and orderly operation and discipline of the school or school activities, and (2) creating and/or distributing written, printed, or electronic material, including photographic material and blogs, that causes substantial disruption to school operations or interferes with the rights of other students or staff members.
13. The Superintendent or designee shall fully inform staff members of the District's goal to prevent students from engaging in bullying and the measures being used to accomplish it. This includes each of the following:
- a. Communicating the District's expectation and State law requirement that teachers and other certificated or licensed employees maintain discipline.
 - b. Establishing the expectation that staff members: (1) intervene immediately to stop a bullying incident that they witness or immediately contact building security and/or law enforcement if the incident involves a weapon or other illegal activity, (2) report bullying, whether they witness it or not, to an administrator, and (3) inform the administration of locations on school grounds where additional supervision or monitoring may be needed to prevent bullying.

- c. Where appropriate in the staff development program, providing strategies to staff members to effectively prevent bullying and intervene when it occurs.
- d. Establishing a process for staff members to fulfill their obligation to report alleged acts of bullying.

Adopted: June 11, 2024

Policy 4:80- Reporting Fraud and Financial Abuse

Internal Controls

The Superintendent is primarily responsible for establishing and implementing a system of internal controls for safeguarding the District's financial condition; the Board, however, will oversee these safeguards. The control objectives are to ensure efficient business and financial practices, reliable financial reporting, and compliance with State law and Board policies, and to prevent losses from fraud, waste, and abuse, as well as employee error, misrepresentation by third parties, or other imprudent employee action.

Please report any suspected instances of fraud or fiscal mismanagement to:

Ted N. Sanders, Superintendent, or

Melitsa Marxman, Bookkeeper

Adopted: January 19, 2021

Teacher Responsibilities

Registering Credentials

Your teaching license must be registered every five years with the Regional Office of Education in Ottawa. This may be taken care of at the Superintendent's office or we will send your certificate in at the end of the each school year in which your certificate renewal expires. All teachers must have a copy of their license on file in the school office. Teachers moving into the county from another county or out of state must register their teaching certificate at the Regional Office of Education in Ottawa.

Transcript

Each teacher is required by law to file in the office of Grand Ridge School a certified copy of his/her transcripts. If you have a transcript on file in the office now, and you have completed college work during the past year, you must bring it up to date as soon as possible. The transcript is used to determine your place on the salary schedule and for completing state reports. Please refer to the Teacher's contract.

Physical Examination

All new employees are required to have a physical examination and TB test before the start of the school year. The physical must be by a doctor licensed to practice in Illinois. Expense is the responsibility of the employee.

Teacher's Hours

Teachers are required to be at school by 8:00 am and stay until 3:30 pm. Teachers are to be in their classrooms by 8:15 a.m.

Faculty/Committee Meetings

All general faculty meetings will be held the Wednesday at 2:20 p.m. (Early Dismissal). There are a number of committees that meet during the year in that time slot. All teachers are expected to attend these meetings, unless excused by the Principal or Superintendent. Do not make any appointments for those days or schedule practices prior to 3:30pm. Throughout the year we will also utilize 11:50 dismissals on Wednesdays for School Improvement. Meetings will vary based on the School Improvement Schedule. Teachers should plan to attend until 3:30pm. Do not make appointments or schedule practices during School Improvement days.

Dress Code

The teachers, staff, and administration are expected to dress professionally for their job. Exceptions are during spirit week and some field trips. Also on Fridays blue jeans may be worn. During warm months shorts are allowed.

Teacher's Lunch

Notify the office that you will be having lunch as soon as possible in the morning. Adult lunches may be charged and the office will bill you monthly. Cost of adult lunches changes annually based on permitted rates.

Teachers' Lounge/Workroom

The Teachers' Lounge, also called the Teachers' Workroom, is located in room 128 across from the multipurpose room/cafeteria. There is a refrigerator and freezer for your convenience.

Absences of Teachers

Please call the principal as early as possible. The principal will work with the office secretaries to contact substitutes. All teachers are to fill out a **“Personal Absence Record”** for all absences. Please write the date, the day(s) absent, and the reason for the absence: Sick/Bereavement/Personal. Please turn in your Personal Absence Record to the bookkeeper. For information about total sick day and bereavement day allotments, please refer to the Teacher Contract for details.

Personal Day

If you will need a personal day, a request sheet needs to be approved by the Superintendent and he will inform the Principal that a substitute is needed. You may complete the Personal Day form, along with a Personal Absence Record form and submit to the Bookkeeper. For information about total personal day allotments, please refer to the Teacher Contract for details.

Bereavement

Unfortunately there may be times when you must utilize days for a death in the family. We are very understanding of each situation. Please refer to the Teacher contract for details.

Teacher Plan Book/Substitute Folder

The purpose of the plan book is to give direction and to keep a record of daily class progress. The plan book will be checked periodically by the Principal. You should also have a Substitute Folder. Plan books are provided by the district and are ordered annually. The Substitute (Sub) Folder is necessary for a substitute teacher who may replace you for one or more days and needs to have all materials and information that a sub might require to teach your class.

1. Each day's work in all subject areas should be complete in enough detail so a person unfamiliar with the work can carry on.
2. Materials or books should be identified by name and page numbers.
3. Make sure to specify the materials needed for projects, individual, and group work.
4. Have more than enough material for a substitute to work from, including worksheets,
5. A daily schedule must be posted in the classroom and be included in the sub folder.
6. A classroom roster should be kept in the plan book and sub folder.
7. Any extra duty (lunch room supervisor, etc.) should be explained in detail.
8. Emergency procedures should be included in your sub-folder.

Professional Growth

The board and administration encourage teachers to take courses and further your education. Courses must be approved in advance by the Superintendent. Upon successful course completion, transcripts may be turned in to the bookkeeper for financial reimbursement according to the Teacher Contract. Courses taken and completed after the opening of the school year will not qualify for advancement on the salary schedule until the next year's contract. Please refer to Professional Growth in the Teacher's Contract.

Professional Development and Workshops

Teachers are required to attend the Regional Teacher's Institute in the fall. Also, teachers shall be allowed reimbursement for mileage as per IRS standards, meals, fee, lodging and registration to attend meeting and workshops if attendance and reimbursement is approved in advance by the Superintendent.

School Calendar and Events

Check the master calendar in the office for information regarding school-related events. **Any event changes or additions to the school calendar need to be approved by the principal and/or superintendent in order to avoid conflicts.**

School Sponsored Activities

Prior approval for all school activities must be given by the principal or superintendent. Please see that all such activities are scheduled and placed on the school calendar well in advance of the proposed date.

Field Trips

If you plan a field trip, the following will need to be submitted to the office:

1. Field Trip Request Form.
2. Student list assigned by bus.
3. List of Chaperones and phone numbers.

Take a copy of the roster, safety handbook, first aid kit, and any student medications.

Bus Request

Teachers need to inform the administration of the bus request.

Parent/Teacher Conferences

Parent/Teacher conferences are held in October at the end of the 1st quarter. Teachers are expected to attend and keep a log of parent contacts. Turn your contact list into the office after conferences have been completed.

Parent/Teacher Correspondences

All written communications to parents in regard to student conduct or discipline must be approved by an administrator. Positive communications do not need prior approval. Be sure to log all parent communications positive or negative in nature.

Attending School Functions

We encourage teachers and staff to support our students by attending after school events such as ball games and concerts. While not a requirement, your attention goes a long way to help build the school/community relationship.

Supply Drop-off Night/Parent-Teacher Conferences/Open House

Teachers are required to attend the Fall Supply Drop-off night, Parent Teacher Conferences, and the Spring Open House Night.

Graduation

It is requested, but not required by contract, that all teachers should plan to attend graduation.

On the last day of school, the following should be turned in to the office:

1. Employee Handbook
2. Student Files/Cumulative folders
3. Safety Binders

****Also, please pay any charges that you might have for lunches before your last day.**

Daily Duties

Bus/Crosswalk/Door Duty assignments

Teachers may be assigned a duty on a rotational basis to ensure the safe entrance and exit of our students from the school grounds. These duties will be assigned at the beginning of the year. **If you run into a conflict, you are to find your own replacement and let the principal know of the switch.** If you are unexpectedly absent, the office will provide coverage for duties.

Daily Attendance Breakfast/Lunch Reports

The Daily Attendance reports will be submitted electronically via Teacher Ease. To submit attendance go to the Teacher Ease Application on the computer screen. Click on Please complete the Daily Attendance Reports along with the daily lunch and breakfast counts each morning before **8:30 a.m.** All fees will be paid in the office or online through Teacher Ease.

If the Internet is down at attendance time, it will be necessary to submit attendance by a hand written report. The Daily Attendance Reports will be picked up at your door, along with the daily lunch and breakfast count each morning by 8:45 a.m. Make sure you sign your name and date the report. If all students are present you should put ALL PRESENT on the report. If a student leaves school or enters school after the attendance report has been turned in, the office will take care of making the change. Make sure to ask the student if they have checked in at the office. If a student is leaving school early, they must have a note from their parent and should give it to the teacher or present it to the office in the morning. Refer to the Parent/Student Handbook.

Student Absences – Parents are to notify the school office by **9:00 a.m.** if a student will be absent. Parents who request a pre-planned student absence should provide notes, excuses, etc., to the homeroom teacher, or notify the office.

Tardiness –Students arriving to class after **8:15am** are counted tardy by the homeroom teacher and should be sent to the office for a tardy slip. Students are required to present a tardy slip to the teacher (issued by the office) before they may be admitted to class.

Requests for Homework – When a parent or student requests homework during an absence, please make every effort to include any necessary materials with the assignment sheets. Assignment sheets and materials may then be sent to the office.

Milk Break

Students in grades K-2 may have a milk break in the morning. Milk money for K-2 is paid by the parent at time of registration, or online through Teacher Ease. The teacher is responsible for communicating with the cafeteria so they know how much milk and what kind will be needed each day.

Excuses from Class

If you wish to send a student on an errand, please give him/her a pass. This applies to all students. Any student who comes to the office **MUST** have a pass from the teacher. Students should not be allowed to leave class to use the phone. This should be done during their lunch hour or if absolutely necessary, they may use the phone between classes. The teacher should not leave students unattended or unsupervised.

School Nurse

The nurse's office is located in the hallway between the library and the gym lobby. The nurse is available all day for dispensing medications and meeting with students.

Discipline

Grand Ridge is a Positive Behavior Interventions and Supports (PBIS) school, and we utilize Office Discipline Referrals (ODRs) to communicate disciplinary actions with students to the parents and the office. As a professional teacher, you are trained and qualified to handle disciplinary problems and classroom management for minor infractions. (See Appendix G). The Principal is available for consultation and for major behavior violations. **Please follow the Student/Parent Handbook concerning discipline and PBIS procedures.**

Teaching Character and Moral Values

Teaching character is part of board policy and Illinois School Code. Teachers are required to teach character education that includes respect, responsibility, fairness, caring, trustworthiness, and citizenship for the purpose of lessening crime and raising the standard of good character for our community.

District Grading/Testing/Evaluation

Grading Practice

The purpose of grading students is to evaluate knowledge in a certain skill or content. Once grading has been done, the teacher is able to assess what needs to be taught or re-taught in order to help each student be successful. For grading to be fair and accurate, students should have several grades per week including, but not limited to:

1. homework
2. participation
3. conduct
4. quizzes
5. tests
6. special projects

A student's grade should not be based on one assignment or test. It is the responsibility of the teacher to devise methods to accurately monitor and evaluate student performance. Please refer to the Parent Student handbook for more information.

Eligibility

In order for students to be eligible to participate in IESA activities, they must be passing every class with a **D** or better at the end of each week. **Teachers must post grades for eligibility by Thursday at 4pm** so letters may be mailed home to parents on Friday for the students who are deemed ineligible for IESA competition. See the **Extra Curricular Policy** for further information regarding eligibility requirements.

Report Cards/Progress Reports

The teacher should make every effort to communicate with parents about their child's grades. Parents have access to student grades online, but if a student is struggling, it helps to keep them informed through emails or other notifications.

At the end of each quarter, teachers are to enter grades for each section and subject area for which you are responsible. Our school calendar will include the last day of grading for each quarter, and the date that grades are due for the office. We utilize Teacher Ease for our student data system. Once all grades are submitted, the office may prepare report cards. Please review them before distributing, and notify the office of any corrections.

Illinois Assessment of Readiness (IAR)

IAR is the State of Illinois' federally mandated test for grades 3-8. Students are assessed in March or April, and results are reported on the State of Illinois School Report Card. We receive individual student scores in October of the following year. The office will distribute these results to homeroom teachers. The teacher should review the information to guide education practices, and send a copy home to the parents, usually during parent/teacher conferences.

Student Cumulative Folders

Keep up to date. Turn all cumulative folders into the office the last day of school. Place grades in space provided on the folder. This folder is considered part, but not all, of the student's temporary file.

Permanent and Temporary File Definitions

The Illinois School Code (105 ILCS 10/2) defines the following terms:

Student Permanent Record (For GRGS we use a Green Card for Records) The minimum personal information necessary to a school in the education of the student and contained in a school student record. Such information may include the student's name, birth date, address, grades, and grade level, parents' names and addresses, attendance records, and such other entries as the State Board may require or authorize.

Student Temporary Record (for GRGS we call it the Cumulative Folder) All information contained in a school student record but not contained in the student permanent record. Such information may include family background information, intelligence test scores, aptitude test scores, psychological and personality test results, teacher evaluations, and other information of clear relevance to the education of the student, all subject to regulations of the State Board. The information shall include information provided under Section 8.6 of the Abused and Neglected Child Reporting Act. In addition, the student temporary record shall include information regarding serious disciplinary infraction that resulted in expulsion, suspension, or the imposition of punishment or sanction. For purposes of this provision, serious disciplinary infractions means: infractions involving drugs, weapons, or bodily harm to another.

PRIVACY ACT

Guidelines for viewing student records are in the Student/Parent Handbook. Records must be kept on all students in the Grand Ridge Community Consolidated School District #95. Parents must notify the office to view a student's cumulative records. If there is a challenge by the parent, it must be written, and an opportunity will be given to the parent to provide specific evidence and statements. The parent must give opportunity for rebuttal, evidence, and statements. This may include the teacher who entered the information. All records must remain within the school building.

Educational personnel have a burden to document the validity and appropriateness of entries in the student's records. These two questions should be utilized to determine if an item of information should be placed in a student's file.

- 1. Will the information be helpful to other school personnel who will come in contact with the student?**
- 2. Is the information objective, evidence-based, and factual?**

No teacher or other staff personnel is to release information on students to outside agencies, etc., unless permission is granted, in writing, by the parent or guardian.

Method of Handling Possible Retention

Call parents for conference as soon as possible. If needed, consult the principal and superintendent and let them know when you have scheduled this type of conference. Make sure a student's grades and general work call for retention. The Parent /Student Handbook has guidelines on retention for the parents and guardians.

Referral Process for Students with Special Needs

Psychologist & Social Worker Referral Procedure

A student is referred for special education services only after

1. Several interventions have been attempted without success and the Problem Solving Team (PST) determines further assistance is necessary.
2. A discrepancy is discovered that warrants additional services.
3. An emergency situation has occurred, such as a traumatic brain injury or other physical injury, which requires immediate assistance through an IEP.

RtI

RtI means Response To Intervention, and is a 3-tiered system of interventions and supports our district utilizes to meet the individual academic needs of our students. (See Decision Making Rules and RtI 3-Tiered System of Supports chart in Appendix E)

PBIS

PBIS means Positive Behavior Interventions and Supports, and is a system of interventions our district utilizes to meet the individual behavioral needs of our students. (See PBIS 3-tiered System of Supports in Appendix G)

General Information

Telephone Usage

Telephones are located in the office, Superintendent's office, Principal's office, the psychologist's office, nurses office, cafeteria, and the teachers' lounge. Phone calls should be limited to school use and local calls. Teachers will not be called from their classrooms to the phone except for emergencies.

Requisitions

If you have a request for supplies and/or materials, you should complete a Purchase Order and turn in to the Superintendent for approval. Purchase orders can be picked up in the office from the bookkeeper.

Maintenance

Please email the custodian for any of your maintenance concerns.

Allowance for Miscellaneous Supplies

The PTO offers \$200 to teachers for supplies for the school year.

Selling Merchandise

Selling or soliciting at the school is prohibited, except with permission of the Superintendent.

Accident Reports

If a significant accident occurs while you are supervising a group, you will be expected to complete an *“Accident Report Form”* and return it to the office.

Medicine

Do not issue any type of medication to a student. Parents should not send medicine with a student. All medicine should be dropped off in the office by the adult. Medicine is to be administered by the school nurse.

Gym and Locker Rooms

Students may not play on the gym floor unattended and they should change into gym shoes before PE or recess. Locker rooms are off limits unless students are changing for PE class and must be supervised at all times.

P.T.O.

Grand Ridge has a Parent Teacher Organization. The PTO raises money for school activities and special events and they provide teachers a stipend of \$200 for items you purchase for your classrooms. They have several meetings held throughout the year and you are encouraged to attend. Meetings are the first Wednesday of each month at 7:00pm in the multipurpose room or library. Teachers are encouraged to attend.

Supplies

General office supplies are located in the Teacher Work Room/Lounge Room #128. Extra construction paper is also located in the south room on the stage. Any additional needs may be submitted with a Purchase Order (PO) and will be approved by administration and ordered through the office with regard to budgetary appropriations and restrictions.

Housekeeping

It is acceptable and advised to expect students to help with certain daily housekeeping duties in order to teach orderliness and responsibility. To keep the school neat and clean, please expect your children to do the following:

1. Keep books and materials neatly arranged and in appropriate locations.
2. Clean and empty pencil sharpeners.
3. Erase white boards daily.
4. Keep desks and surrounding area clean and free from tripping hazards.
5. Pick up after yourself.
6. Keep extra shoes and clothing in lockers.
7. Keep shelves neat and uncluttered.
8. Turn off lights when the room is not in use.
9. Turn off water faucets.
10. Clean and remove all items from desk tops at the end of each day in order for custodial staff to clean and sanitize hard surfaces.

Acknowledgement

I have received, read, and agree to comply with Grand Ridge District 95 policies and procedures.

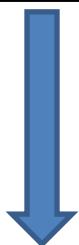
Employee Signature

Date

PBIS 3-tiered System of Supports Grand Ridge CCSD #95

Tier 1 (Universal Team)

This tier includes everyone: parents, teachers, students, and staff. There is a Team comprised of representative members of each of these groups with the responsibility of planning school-wide and class-wide supports.



Universal Support Systems

Mohawk Bucks
Mohawk Store
Classroom Incentives
Reward Parties
Beginning and End-of-year Celebrations
Student of the Month

Tier 2 (Secondary Team)

This tier is made up of specialized members who are trained in behavior intervention strategies. (Special Education Teachers, Social Worker, Administrators) This team uses data to prescribe interventions and determine overall intervention effectiveness.

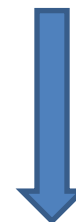


Secondary Support Systems

Check in Check Out (CICO)
CICO with Individualized Features
Social Academic Intervention Group (SAIG)
SAIG with Individualized Features
Brief FBA/BIP

Tier 3 (Tertiary Team)

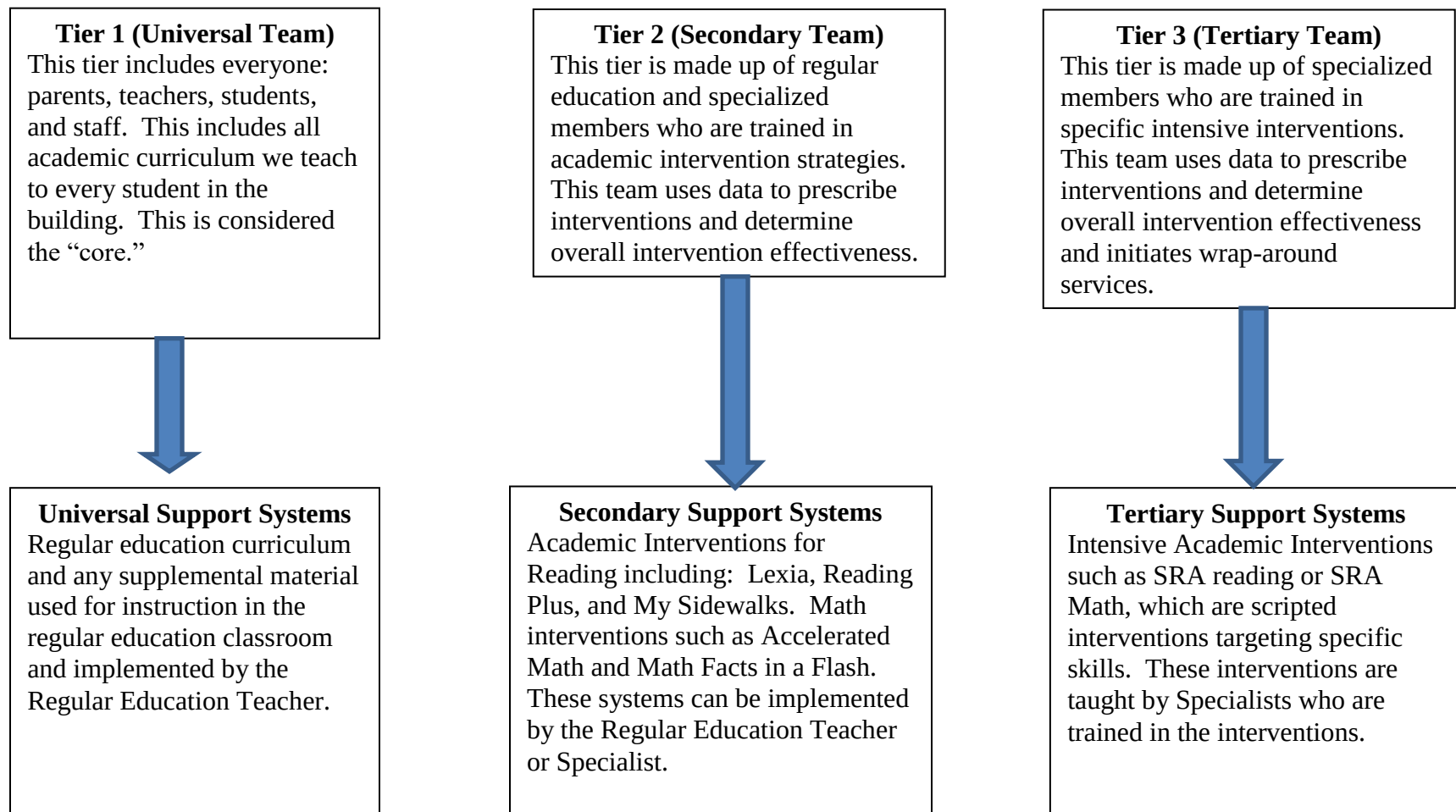
This tier is made up of specialized members who are trained in Functional Behavior Assessments (FBA) and Behavior Intervention Plans (BIP). This team uses data to prescribe interventions and determine overall intervention effectiveness and initiates wrap-around services.



Tertiary Support Systems

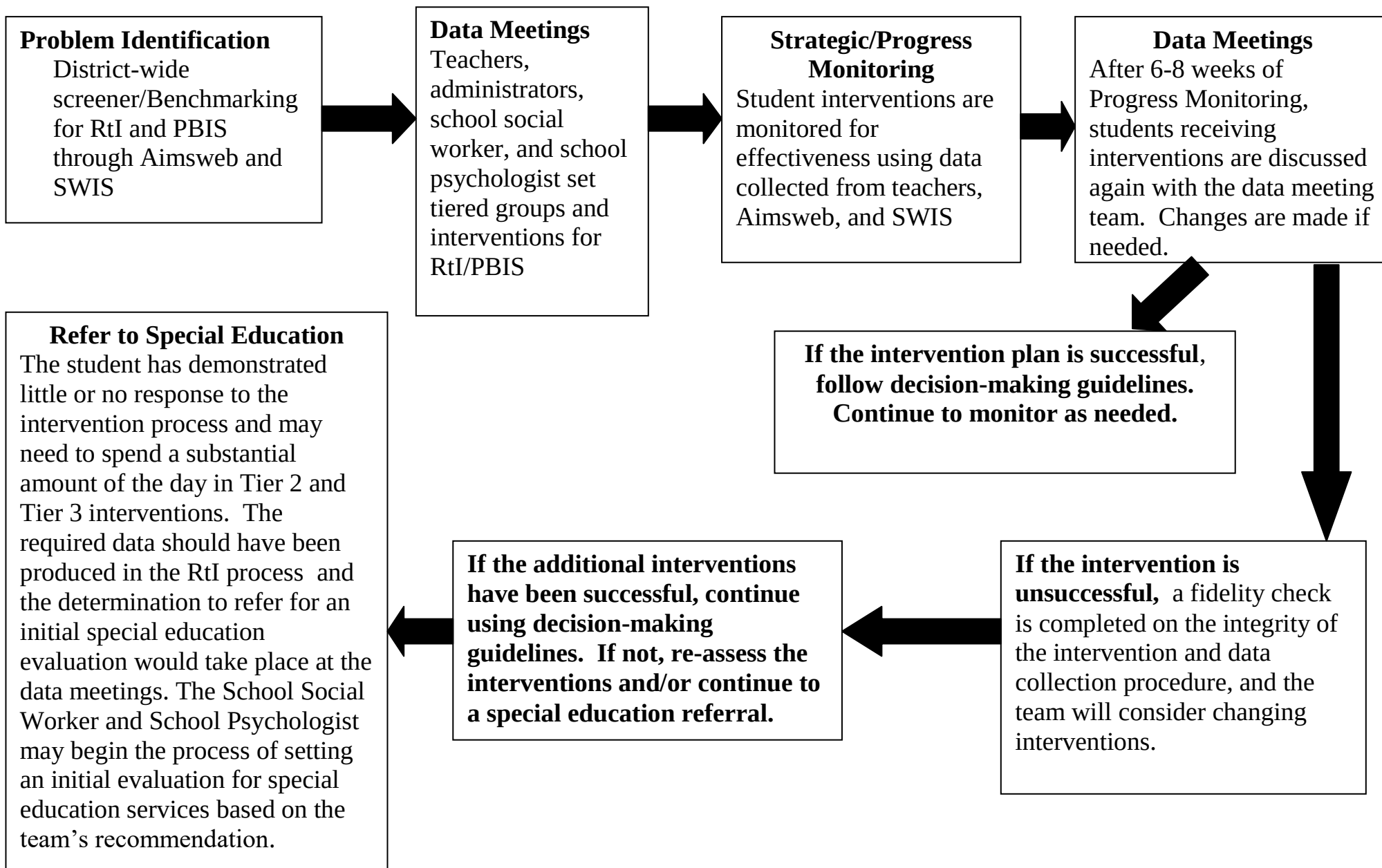
Complex FBA/BIP
Wrap-around services
Outside Agencies

RtI 3-tiered System of Supports Grand Ridge CCSD #95



Special Education Referral Process

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**Decision-Making Rules for Data Meetings
And Progress Monitoring for Grand Ridge**

STUDENTS TO START INTERVENTIONS IMMEDIATELY IN THE FALL:

Students, who have been identified in May as needing Tier 2 or Tier 3 Interventions, will begin receiving interventions immediately at the start of the school year, prior to Fall Benchmarking.

BENCHMARKING AND PLACEMENT IN INTERVENTIONS:

At Benchmarking, any student who is “in the Yellow” or “Red,” shall **start immediately in a Tier 2 or Tier 3 intervention and shall be Progress Monitored** based on discussion during data meetings.

PROGRESS MONITORING AND GOAL SETTING:

Progress Monitoring (P.M.) will begin after the Fall Benchmarking Meeting. The **Default P.M. level** will be Grade-level Probes and Goal set to 50th percentile of multi-year aggregate scores from the AIMSweb Growth Table. (**Please note that students who are performing between the 25th - 75th percentile or higher are *still* in the average range when we consider the bell curve.)

If a student has 3 of the last 4 data points at or **above** their AIM-line:

1. Drop intervention and
2. Continue to P.M. until 3 of the last 4 data points are at/above their AIM-line.
(**Remember the student will be P.M. every other week so the student will be P.M. over 6-8 weeks.)
3. Discontinue P.M.

Once a student is “in the Green,” it is the role and responsibility of the classroom teacher to prevent regression to “Yellow” or “Red”, through **delivery of a strong core**.

SURVEY LEVEL ASSESSMENT

If a student is benchmarked below the 10th percentile on AIMSweb aggregate norms survey level assessments should be used to determine the student’s current performance level. When using survey level assessments, enter the scores from the most recent benchmark, then have student read three passages from successive grade levels until the student meets or exceeds the 50th percentile of that level on the AIMSweb growth table.

STUDENTS FALLING BELOW AIM LINE DURING PROGRESS MONITORING:

If a student has 3 or more data points **that show that he is not progressing**, complete Fidelity Check, and change intervention if no problems with Fidelity.

FIDELITY CHECKS

If a student has 5 or more data points below their aim line, complete Fidelity Check and consider changing intervention. The LEASE Coordinator or the school psychologist will perform Fidelity Check on main interventionist. Main interventionist will perform Fidelity Check on volunteers. Periodically through the year, Fidelity Checks should be completed for interventionists.

STUDENTS ON “WATCHLIST”:

Students placed on “**Watchlist**” at Benchmarking or P.M. Data Meetings **will receive no pullout interventions, but will be strategic monitored** (set up as P.M. on AIMSweb and get 1 data points per month, instead of weekly), to prompt review and decision-making at next meeting. If student maintains, they will be removed from Watchlist at next Data Meeting.

ADDITIONAL CONSIDERATIONS:

Additional considerations to be documented for decision-making can include, but are not limited to: students’ current grades, unit test results, Star Reader results, Star Math results, and student-specific factors, such as attendance, illness, home supports (or lack thereof); or students who speak very slowly, and therefore may score low, yet are doing well academically.

Revised January 2011
Grand Ridge District Leadership Team